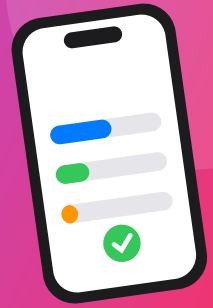


Rescue Your iPhone Storage

Squash a bloated "System Data" and keep every photo, message, and app. No new phone required.



67.85 GB

SYSTEM DATA BEFORE



89.61 GB free

38.39 OF 128 GB USED

Is this you?

Settings > General > iPhone Storage says **System Data** is huge (normal is about 5-15 GB) and nothing you delete makes a dent. That's leftover clutter Settings can't touch. The fix Apple supports: back up, erase, restore. Your stuff comes back, the junk doesn't.

Pack your patience

Grab Wi-Fi, a charger, and your Apple ID password. Budget about an hour. Grab a snack while it works.

PART 1

Get ready

1

Check your iCloud space

Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud. Short on room? Rent a bigger plan for a month. It's cheap insurance.

2

Switch on iCloud Backup

Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud > iCloud Backup, then flip it on.

3

Back up right now, and check it

Tap **Back Up Now** and stay on Wi-Fi. When it finishes, 'Last successful backup' must say **today, a few minutes ago**. Don't move on until you see that.



4

Rescue anything not in iCloud

Make sure Photos are synced or exported. Note apps that keep data only on the phone (some authenticators and game saves).

PART 2

Erase (deep breath)

1

Find the big button

Settings > General > Transfer or Reset iPhone > **Erase All Content and Settings** > Continue.

2

eSIM? Pick 'Keep eSIM and Erase Data'

Your cellular plan stays put, so there's no calling the carrier later.

3

Say yes to the Find My prompt

Tap Continue and enter your Apple ID password. With AppleCare+ Theft and Loss? Relax: this pauses Find My for a bit, it does **not** cancel your coverage.

!

4

Watch it wipe

The phone restarts and greets you with a big friendly 'Hello'.

PART 3

Restore (the fun part)

1

Set up like a new phone

Pick language and region, join Wi-Fi, and let it activate.

2

Choose 'Restore from iCloud Backup'

Sign in with your Apple ID and pick the backup you just made. Check the date and time!

3

Let it cook

Stay on Wi-Fi and plugged in. Apps and photos keep downloading in the background for an hour or more, so numbers settle over time.

4

Log back in to your apps

Banking, streaming, and work apps may ask for a fresh sign-in.

Victory lap

1

Peek at Find My

Settings > [Your Name] > Find My > Find My iPhone. Toggle greyed out while **Find My network** is on? Totally normal with Stolen Device Protection. It's active and your coverage is intact.



2

Check your storage

Settings > General > iPhone Storage. Give it a few hours to recount, then enjoy the space. Ours went from a 67.85 GB System Data monster to 38.39 of 128 GB used, leaving 89.61 GB free. System Data is now a thin sliver of the bar.



Messages says 'Syncing with iCloud paused'?

Very common right after a restore. **1.** Stay on Wi-Fi and charging for 5-10 minutes. **2.** Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud > Messages: toggle off, count to 10, toggle on. **3.** Confirm your backup finished under iCloud Backup. **4.** Still paused after an hour or two? Restart the phone.

Still stuck?

If storage is still huge after everything settles, Apple Support can take a look. Now pass this along to a friend with a full phone!